

Call Prep: Josh Stevenson (Microsoft)

Today, 10:30-11:00 AM CDT (15:30 UTC) — Microsoft Teams

Meeting title: "David O'Hara / Josh Stevenson, Microsoft - Houston AI & Copilot Intro via Jawwad"

Who You're Talking To

Josh Stevenson — Microsoft. LinkedIn bio: "Founder. Builder. Microsoft Innovation Hub Director | AI & Digital Transformation for Companies." You connected on LinkedIn June 16, he messaged you June 29. No prior direct conversation — this is effectively a first real touchpoint.

How You Got Here

Jawwad Baig, MBA made this introduction. He's an existing, warm relationship: AI Business Solutions Executive at Microsoft covering Oil, Gas, Energy & Services, based in Houston. Timeline:

- Met at the Houston AI Tour (~June 9)
- Lunch together June 10 (with Stephen Johnson)
- You thanked him for lunch June 26, referenced Stephen working with him on an account list
- Followed up twice more June 30 asking for that account list — **still outstanding**, no reply on file since

The meeting title includes "Copilot" but that's Alice's calendar labeling, not necessarily Josh's actual focus — don't anchor on it. What matters: Jawwad is routing you to Josh deliberately, not a cold connection.

Why This Matters Right Now

- Yesterday (July 1) you had a related Microsoft call — Maha Abbey and Nick Koury on Responsible AI — explicitly framed as a "Follow-up After Houston AI Tour." Josh's intro is part of the same cluster of Microsoft-Houston relationships spinning out of that event. Worth connecting the dots for him if it's useful context.
- Improving's Microsoft partnership is actively invested right now: a Q1 certification/specializations drive where Dallas and Houston led the readiness list, Nada Ungvarsky (Alliance Partner Manager) and Lowell Messner (SVP Microsoft Practice) own the formal relationship, John Yurewicz is another active contact.
- Rock 4 this quarter (Partner Co-Sell Pipeline) explicitly names Microsoft as one of two priority joint-account plays, with a goal of documenting real pipeline and at least one joint account strategy.

Suggested Agenda

- 1 Thank him for taking the intro from Jawwad — anchor on the Houston AI Tour as the shared starting point.
- 2 Get him to define his lane — "Innovation Hub Director" suggests innovation/transformation work more than a straight sales seat. Ask what that covers day to day.
- 3 Reference Improving's current Microsoft momentum (specializations push, active engagement on Responsible AI just yesterday) to signal you're already leaned in, not starting cold.
- 4 Ask how the Innovation Hub/Center gets best leveraged for him — what is his success actually linked to (customer engagements sourced, deals influenced, adoption metrics, something else)? That answer tells you how Improving can make him look good.

- 5 Surface Executive AI Workshops and customer briefings as a concrete way Improving could plug into that motion — position them as tools that serve whatever his success metric turns out to be, not a generic pitch.
- 6 Find out if there's a specific Houston account or opportunity behind this intro, or if it's pure relationship-building at this stage.
- 7 Close with a clear next step. If the conversation points toward a real co-sell motion, offer to loop in Nada or Lowell — that's the standard path for anything that needs to become a documented joint account play.

Open Item to Consider Raising

If Jawwad comes up, the account list he and Stephen were putting together is still owed to you as of June 30 — a natural, low-friction thing to nudge on either directly with Jawwad after this call or through Josh if it's relevant.

Follow-Up: This Is Pure Relationship Building

Treat this call as relationship-building, not a pipeline motion. The right follow-up is an invite to Improving's Houston Movie Premiere Night — Spider-Man: Brand New Day pre-screening, **Thursday, July 30, 2026**, doors 6:30 PM / film 7:30 PM, Houston Marq'E Stadium 23 IMAX. Improving covers tickets, popcorn, and a soda per guest. Registration: <https://www.improving.com/events/2026/houston-movie-night/>

Send Josh (and Jawwad, if it feels natural) an invite after the call — keeps the relationship warm with zero sales pressure.